government. PM Modi also requested the RJs to provide feedback about the difficulties and challenges faced by the people so that the government can proactively resolve them. He also exhorted the RJs to disseminate positive stories and case studies, particularly of those patients who have fully recovered from coronavirus infection, and also interplay such stories in different parts of the country, thus bringing the entire country together. He appealed to them to showcase and celebrate the contributions of the local heroes like police officers, doctors, nurses, ward boys and other frontline workers at the national level.

He also connected with AYUSH practitioners across the country who spoke about the advantages of using traditional practices in immunity boosting and yoga.

He then interacted with social welfare and spiritual organizations and suggested that they play an important role in arranging for basic necessities for the poor. He appealed to them to dedicate their medical facilities and volunteers to serving patients and the needy in this time of crisis. The prime minister also pressed that they play an active role in countering superstitions, misbeliefs and misinformation. He observed that in the name of beliefs, people have been gathering in various places flouting social-distancing norms. He added that the social welfare and spiritual organizations should actively spread the importance of maintaining social distancing to check the spread of the virus.

The pandemic was a global one and so the problems and solutions would also have to be such. Thus, perhaps in a first-of-its-kind interaction, the prime minister spoke with heads of Indian missions across the world. He directed them to attend to Indians who remain in various foreign countries, given the uncertainty of continuing international travel restrictions. He advised them to help boost the morale of compatriots abroad, and help them address issues arising from their unplanned stay, with their host governments. He also asked them to be compassionate to other problems which Indians might face abroad, including arranging shelter. He added that they stay vigilant and identify in their host countries best practices, innovations, scientific breakthroughs and sources to procure medical equipment to strengthen India’s fight against COVID-19. He also advised them to focus on ensuring seamless coordination with foreign partners so that trade in essential supplies, logistic chains, remittances and such remain unaffected.